NEOLABS

SECURITY LABS · SOC LEVEL 1

# SOC Investigation Templates

Evidence register, query journal and incident-report forms

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**Classification:** Student Training Material

Authorised synthetic training use only.

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Source: templates/evidence-log-template.md

# NeoLabs SOC Evidence Log Template

> Record evidence used in an authorised investigation. This template is for training and case discipline; it does not replace organisational forensic procedures or legal chain-of-custody requirements.

## Case information

| Field | Entry |
|---|---|
| Case / assignment ID | |
| Analyst | |
| Assigned pod | |
| Investigation start | YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC |
| Report path / link | |

## Evidence register

| Evidence ID | Date/ time collected (UTC) | Event time range | Source system | Evidence type | Collection method / query | Original location | File or record hash, when applicable | Handling / redaction note | Releva |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| EV-001 | | | | Alert / raw event / export / screenshot / config / owner confirmation | | | | | |

## Evidence-quality checks

For each important item, consider:

- Was the source operating during the event period?
- Is the timestamp event time, ingest time or alert time?

- Is the time zone known?
- Could the record be duplicated, delayed or truncated?
- Did a decoder or parser alter the displayed fields?
- Is the value source-generated, user-controlled or enrichment data?
- Is the evidence complete enough for the conclusion?
- Was sensitive data redacted without removing necessary meaning?

## Evidence statements

Use one statement per important claim.

**EV-___**

**Observed fact:**

**Source and time:**

**What this evidence supports:**

**What this evidence does not prove:**

**Quality or visibility limitation:**

**Related evidence:**

## Transfer or review record

| Date/time UTC | Evidence ID(s) | From | To / reviewer | Purpose | Method | Confirmation |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

## Final checks

- [ ] Every report fact points to an evidence ID or clearly identified source.
- [ ] No credential, private key or enrolment token is included.
- [ ] Personal or cross-pod information is removed or escalated rather than published.
- [ ] Screenshots show the required context and do not replace available raw records.
- [ ] UTC conversions are documented.
- [ ] Negative findings include the source, query and time range.

Source: templates/query-journal-template.md

# NeoLabs SOC Query Journal Template

> Record searches as they are performed so another analyst can reproduce the investigation. Replace secrets and private endpoints with approved references; never paste enrolment tokens or private keys.

## Case information

| Field | Entry |
|---|---|
| Case / assignment ID | |
| Analyst | |
| Assigned pod | |
| Investigation date | |
| Primary alert | |

## Query register

| Query ID | Time run (UTC) | Platform / source | Exact query or filter | Event-time range | Result count | Important result or negative finding | Evidence IDs | Next pivot |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q-001 | | Wazuh / OpenSearch / local tool | | | | | | |

## Detailed query record

### Q-___

**Question being tested:**

**Data source and index/view:**

**Exact query/filter/command:**

**Time field used:** Event time / ingest time / other
**Time range:**
**Fields displayed or exported:**
**Result summary:**
**Relevant evidence IDs:**
**Limitations:**
**Decision / next query:**

## Query-quality checks

- [ ] The query uses the intended field rather than only free-text search.
- [ ] Exact and analysed fields are distinguished where applicable.
- [ ] The event-time field and time zone are recorded.
- [ ] A zero-result search was checked against source health and retention.
- [ ] Filters inherited from a dashboard or saved view are recorded.
- [ ] Wildcards and broad searches are narrowed before drawing conclusions.
- [ ] Commands were run only against synthetic data or explicitly authorised systems.
- [ ] Output containing sensitive values was redacted before submission.

## Investigation summary

**Most useful query:**

**Most important negative finding:**

**Visibility gap discovered:**

**Queries recommended for higher-tier review:**

Source: templates/incident-report-template.md

# NeoLabs SOC Incident Report Template

> Use for authorised VCC exercises and approved synthetic investigations. Replace instructional text before submission. Do not include credentials, private keys, enrolment tokens or unredacted personal information.

## 1. Report control

| Field | Entry |
|---|---|
| Report title | |
| Case / assignment ID | |
| Analyst name | |
| Track and cohort | SOC Level 1 / |
| Assigned pod | |
| Report version | 1.0 |
| Prepared at | YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM UTC |
| Reviewer | |
| Classification | Training use / confidential programme material as directed |

## 2. Executive summary

Write 3–6 sentences for a reader who may not know Wazuh or the scenario. State:

- what triggered the investigation;
- the affected account, service or asset;
- the most important confirmed facts;
- the current classification and confidence;
- the recommended next action.

Do not include unsupported claims or long raw-log extracts.

# 3. Alert and detection information

| Field | Entry |
|---|---|
| Alert name | |
| Alert / rule ID | |
| Detection source | |
| Alert creation time | |
| Earliest confirmed event time | |
| Tool-assigned severity | |
| Analyst-assigned priority | |
| Relevant ATT&CK behaviour | Optional; explain mapping |

# 4. Scope

## Affected identities

| Identity | Type | Role / context | Confirmed or suspected impact |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |

## Affected assets and services

| Asset / service | Identifier | Criticality / role | Evidence of impact |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |

## Network, file and cloud indicators

| Indicator | Type | Source | Relevance and limitation |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |

# 5. Observed facts

List facts directly supported by evidence. Number each fact so it can be referenced later.

1.
2.
3.

## 6. Timeline

Use UTC unless the assignment specifies otherwise. Separate event time from ingest or alert time when relevant.

| UTC time | Source | Entity | Observed activity | Evidence reference | Confidence |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

## 7. Evidence reviewed

| Evidence ID | Source | Collection / query method | Time range | Integrity or quality note | Location / reference |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| EV-001 | | | | | |

Use the separate evidence log for detailed records.

## 8. Queries performed

| Query ID | Data source | Query / filter | Time range | Result summary | Next pivot |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q-001 | | | | | |

Use the query journal when more detail is required.

## 9. Analysis

### Interpretation

Explain what the combined facts suggest. Connect evidence through identity, time, process, network, session, request, file or resource pivots.

### Alternative explanations considered

| Alternative | Evidence supporting it | Evidence against it | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Open / unlikely / ruled out |

### Visibility gaps and limitations

State missing data, parser failures, disconnected sources, clock issues, retention gaps or permissions that limit the conclusion.

# 10. Classification and confidence

| Field | Entry |
|---|---|
| Classification | False positive / benign positive / suspicious / confirmed incident / insufficient evidence / data-quality issue |
| Confidence | Low / medium / high |
| Confidence reasoning | |
| Potential severity | Informational / low / medium / high / critical, according to assignment definitions |
| Business or lab impact | |

# 11. Actions and recommendations

## Actions already taken

Record only authorised actions actually performed.

1.
2.

## Recommended next actions

| Priority | Recommendation | Owner / escalation target | Reason | Deadline |
|---|---|---|---|---|

Do not claim that a recommendation has been implemented unless evidence confirms it.

# 12. Escalation decision

| Field | Entry |
|---|---|
| Escalated? | Yes / no |
| Escalated to | |
| Time | |
| Reason | |
| Information supplied | |
| Questions requiring higher-tier review | |

## 13. Lessons and detection improvements

- Which field or source was most valuable?
- Which evidence was missing?
- Did the detection title and severity accurately describe the activity?
- What safe tuning, logging or playbook improvement is recommended?
- What should the analyst do differently next time?

## 14. References and attachments

List approved screenshots, exports, evidence IDs, task instructions and public references. Use repository-relative paths where possible. Redact sensitive values.

## 15. Reviewer notes

| Reviewer | Date | Decision | Required corrections |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Approved / revise | |